Hartwell Museum of Natural History

42 Cathedral Lane, Dunbridge, DB3 7QT | www.hartwellmuseum-example.org

Museum Security Specialist

Reference: REF: HMNH-SEC-2026-014

Location:	Hartwell Museum of Natural History, Dunbridge (on-site)
Department:	Facilities & Visitor Safety
Reports to:	Head of Security Operations
Contract:	Permanent, Full-time (40 hrs/week, rolling rota incl. weekends)
Salary:	£28,500 – £33,000 per annum, depending on experience
Start date:	October 2026

About Us

The Hartwell Museum of Natural History welcomes over 480,000 visitors each year and cares for a collection of more than 2.1 million specimens, including irreplaceable palaeontology, mineralogy and taxidermy holdings. Our Security team of 22 officers and specialists works around the clock to protect the collection, our staff and our visitors.

The Role

We are seeking an experienced Museum Security Specialist to take day-to-day responsibility for gallery security operations, alarm and CCTV monitoring, and the protection of high-value and high-risk exhibits. You will act as the escalation point for the duty security team and work closely with curatorial staff on object movements, loans and exhibition installs.

Key Responsibilities

- Conduct scheduled and ad-hoc patrols of galleries, storage areas, rooflines and plant rooms
- Monitor and operate the museum's CCTV, intruder alarm and access-control systems (Gallagher platform)
- Carry out opening and closing procedures, including gallery sweeps and secure lock-up of collection stores
- Supervise object movements, courier arrivals and exhibition installation/de-installation from a security standpoint
- Respond to incidents — including theft attempts, vandalism, fire alarms and medical emergencies — and complete accurate incident reports
- Liaise with police, insurers and external contractors on security matters
- Deliver security inductions and refresher briefings to staff, volunteers and contractors
- Support the annual review of the museum's security risk register and emergency response plans

Essential Requirements

- Minimum 3 years' experience in a security role, ideally within a museum, gallery, heritage site or other public venue
- Valid SIA Door Supervisor or Security Guarding licence (or regional equivalent)
- Working knowledge of CCTV, intruder alarm and access-control systems
- Strong written and verbal communication skills, with experience writing incident reports

- Ability to remain calm and make sound decisions under pressure
- Physically able to patrol a large multi-floor site, including stairs, for extended periods
- Flexible to work early, late, weekend and occasional overnight shifts on a rota basis

Desirable (Not Essential)

- Experience with high-value object protection or art/cultural property security
- First Aid at Work certificate
- Familiarity with the Gallagher or Lenel access-control platforms
- Involvement in exhibition install/de-install projects

What We Offer

- 25 days annual leave plus bank holidays, rising with service
- Employer pension contribution of 6%
- Free museum membership and guest passes
- Uniform and SIA licence renewal costs covered
- Access to staff wellbeing programme and on-site training budget

How to Apply

Please send your CV and a short covering letter (max 1 page) quoting reference HMNH-SEC-2026-014 to recruitment@hartwellmuseum-example.org. Shortlisted candidates will be invited to a panel interview and a practical site walkthrough. This post is subject to an enhanced background check.

Closing date: Friday 4 September 2026, 17:00

SYNTHETIC SAMPLE DOCUMENT — created for CV-screening software testing only. This organisation, vacancy and contact details are fictional.